Siyoung Lee
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EDUCATION

Sogang University, Republic of Korea — Sep 2025–Present
M.A. in Economics (in progress, GPA: 4.30/4.30)

Sogang University, Republic of Korea — Aug 2025
B.A. in Economics (GPA: 4.27/4.30)
B.S. in Mathematics (GPA: 4.05/4.30)

- Ranked 1st in the School of Economics (out of 63 graduates)
- Graduated early, completing both degrees in seven semesters
- Honors in Economic Theory

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Macroeconomics, International Finance, Spatial Economics, Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

"Correlated Country Risk and International Capital Allocation"
(with Jun Hee Kwak) [Link]

- *Role:* Originated the research question and carried out the project from data construction and model development through estimation and quantitative simulations.
- *Abstract:* Investigates how geographically correlated characteristics of investment destinations shape international capital allocation and interest rate differences. Documents that bilateral interest rate differentials increase systematically with geographic distance. Develops and estimates a multi-country general equilibrium model that distinguishes spatially correlated destination characteristics from bilateral portfolio frictions. Quantifies their contributions to interest rate dispersion and the long-run distribution of capital and output.

"Sensitivity Analysis in Sharp Regression Discontinuity Designs"
(with Sungwon Lee, Sukyung Joo, and Beomsu Kim) [Link]

- *Abstract:* Develops a partial identification framework for extrapolating causal effects beyond the cutoff in sharp regression discontinuity designs. Derives sharp bounds on counterfactual distribution functions under smoothness restrictions characterized by interpretable sensitivity parameters. Demonstrates the method through Monte Carlo simulations and an empirical application on external validity.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Research Center for Big Data on Korean Economy — May 2025–Present

Project: *"The Geography of Fertility: Theory and Evidence from Korea"*

Co-PIs: **Costas Arkolakis (Yale), Jun Hee Kwak (Sogang), Hyunjoo Yang (Sogang)**

- Contributed to the development of the project's structural estimation strategy by deriving an estimable equation for parameter identification and implementing the corresponding estimation procedure.
- Conducted reduced-form empirical analyses, including the development of empirical specifications, variable construction, estimation, and robustness checks across multiple levels of geographic aggregation.
- Constructed administrative and geographic datasets and integrated them with existing population-scale financial, mobility, and consumption microdata. Developed procedures to process and validate the proprietary microdata against administrative records.

Research Assistant for **Prof. Jun Hee Kwak (Sogang)** — Mar 2025–Jul 2025

- Constructed a sanctions measure for the project and conducted regression analyses.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"A Spatial Theory of Exchange Rate Disconnect"

- Develops an open economy model of exchange rates to study how geographic frictions shape the cross-country transmission of financial shocks.

PRESENTATIONS

- The International Symposium on Econometric Theory and Applications, Tokyo, Japan — Jun 2026
- KER International Conference, Jeju, Republic of Korea — Jun 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Younghoon Lee — Sep 2025–Present

- Econometrics, Economic Statistics

Tutor, Economics Study Center, Sogang Univ — Sep 2025–Present

- Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics, Applied Econometrics, Economic Statistics

SCHOLARSHIPS / FELLOWSHIPS

Albatross Fellowship, Sogang Univ — Sep 2025–Present

Brain Korea 21-Four Fellowship, Sogang Univ — Sep 2025–Present

TA Scholarship, Sogang Univ — Sep 2025–Present

Dean's List Award ×3 , Sogang Univ — Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall 2023

Academic Excellence Award (Top 1% of students), Sogang Univ — Fall 2021

Integrated Undergrad-Grad Degree Program Scholarship, Sogang Univ. — Spring 2024 – Spring 2025

SELECTED COURSEWORK

Economics
Macroeconomics (G), Advanced Topics in Macroeconomics (G), International Finance (G), Microeconomics (G), Econometrics (G), Microeconometrics (G), Dynamic Programming

Mathematics & Statistics
Real Analysis (G), Advanced Mathematical Statistics (G), Advanced Linear Algebra (G), Topology I–II, Advanced Calculus I–II, Mathematical Statistics, Probability Theory

(G) denotes graduate-level coursework.

SKILLS

Programming & Software: Python, Stata, Julia, MATLAB, LaTeX

Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)